

Industry News

3D TV sales to touch 78 million by 2015

Global sales of 3D TVs will reach 78 million units by 2015, up from 4.2 million in 2010, reports iSuppli. Revenues are expected to hit \$64.3 billion, up from an estimated \$7.4 billion this year.

"Announcements made before and after the 2010 Consumer Electronics Show in January indicate that 3D TV is becoming a reality," iSuppli analyst Riddhi Patel said. "At the event, top television brands including Sony, LG, Panasonic and Samsung showcased upcoming offerings of full-featured 3D TVs in the home. Furthermore, consumer electronics makers at CES announced 3D Blu-ray players and home theatre systems, providing critical support that will help 3D to move beyond a niche market and enter the mainstream in the coming years."

By 2015, prices of 3D TVs are expected to fall by more than 50 per cent.

The future of cellphones is touchscreen!

Gartner estimates the global market for touchscreen mobiles to cross 362.7

million units in 2010—a 96.8 per cent increase from the 184.3 million units sold in 2009. And by 2013, touchscreen mobiles will account for 58 per cent of all global mobile sales, and more than 80 per cent in high-end markets, such as North America and Western Europe.

"Touchscreens are no longer the preserve of high-end devices and are now being included in many mid-range phones as more companies have been driving the consumer market for affordable touchscreen phones," said Roberta Cozza, principal research analyst, Gartner. "As phone capabilities increase, consumers are becoming much more aware of the benefits of touch interfaces, and vendors are responding."

Chip design costs set to rise

Chip design costs will soar in the next three years, warns Walden Rhines, chairman and chief executive, Mentor Graphics.

IC design costs, which were \$20-50 million, are expected to hit \$100 million within three years. This will be problematic for electronic design automation vendors as designers may no longer be able to buy

In Focus

HP appoints Srivastava as COO

Hewlett-Packard (HP) India has appointed Rajiv Srivastava as chief operating officer. In this role, Srivastava will be a part of the central leadership team of HP in India and will be responsible for driving the company's growth and business performance. He will be in charge of managing the overall commercial and financial impact across all organisational decisions and activities.

Srivastava will report to Neelam Dhawan, managing director, HP India.

their tools.

The real issue is not the hardware costs, which are somewhat flat. IC design costs are soaring owing to the increasing cost of the embedded software, says Rhines.

Electronics sales up despite recession

According to a recent report by iSuppli Corp., despite the global recession, worldwide spending on electronic products increased in 2009. The firm estimates that global revenues from shipments of smartphones rose by 9.6 per cent, while LCD TVs saw a 14 per cent increase. For netbooks, the figure was an astounding 90 per cent.

"In a time of great economic distress, when people had less money and spending on essentials like food and rent declined, consumers surprisingly used a disproportionate amount of their money to purchase new consumer electronics products," said Derek Lidow, president and CEO, iSuppli.

However, the supply of most electronic components remains restricted, as suppliers are yet to fully ramp up capacity.



Pixon M8800, Samsung 8 megapixel touchscreen camera mobile phone launched in India recently